

Tiny Skeleton Recalls 1835 Island Saga

Bones Believed Those of Mystery Hermit's Child

BY THE SHEL

Arthur R. Sanger has a skeleton in his closet. Actually, of course, it isn't really in his closet but in a display case in a small compartment of Sanger's living room at 2910 S. Blanding Ave.

And it isn't a skeleton that Sanger is ashamed of. Indeed, he is proud of it. The skeleton, Sanger believes, is the skeleton of the child of the 19th century hermit of San Nicolas Island.

The hermit, a figure of mystery in Southern California history, was a woman left behind and alone when the last of the San Nicolas Indians were moved from the island in 1835.

As the four or five stragglers to sail, an Indian woman leaped ashore to tell her history but it her baby, ever since, has been haunting the coast of Indians were brought to the ship.

Measured on island, a storm drove away the boat and the woman was drowned in 18th century years on the wind-whipped island.

When she was taken off by whaler vessel in 1852, her remains were buried but her husband had been reassured that her baby had died with wild dogs years earlier.

Sanger's skeleton, he believes, is that of the child for whose life a mother became a solitary hunter on San Nicolas.

Found in a floodup spot another mound of sand, Sanger's skeleton was buried with beads which, he has ascertained, must have been imported to the island at a fairly late date.

Recent finding The fact that the skeleton is of a child has not been uncovered by the constant gales sweeping the island, Sanger says. It is evidence that the grave was of fairly recent origin. Most archeologists, he said, are unimpressed by the winds rearranging island sands.

The skeleton is that of a small child, buried according to Indian custom in a fetal position.

"The Indians believed," Sanger says in a letter to the Times.

DOWNTOWN AREA STORES WILL BE CLOSED TODAY

In observance of the Fourth of July holiday, downtown stores will be closed today.

Harry Morrison, general manager of the area stores, said that many stores will be open today.

Many stores will be open today, Morrison said, to accommodate customers who usually shop on Monday night.



FIREWORKS DISPLAY—One of dazzling displays of pyrotechnics offered before 70,000 spectators at annual Fourth of July program in the Memorial Coliseum.

Woman Saved in Apartment House Blaze

A 35-year-old, single woman owed her life yesterday to an alert neighbor and to firemen who carried her unconscious to the hospital.

Firemen said Mrs. Maxine Violet Wheeler of 218D S. Wabash St. was overcome Saturday night by smoke flooding her room by a smoldering cigarette bed at the furniture shop.

The neighbor, John Kearns of 1142 W. Arthur Vista St., saw the smoke and summoned firemen.

Acting Fire Capt. D. J. Reynolds found her slumped on the door beside her bed.

Driver Aims at Own Garage—Ruins Another

Harry Shidley's misadventure, blood garage door, slammed into his parking his car yesterday, the opposite wall and finally came to a halt, against a chain link fence on the other side of the yard.

When Villa got home, he found a hole in his garage big enough to drive Harry Shidley's car through.

As Shidley's officers moved, he found his car shattered Villa's car.

The neighbor, John Kearns of 1142 W. Arthur Vista St., saw the smoke and summoned firemen.

College Girls Help Clean Picnic Ground

Fourth of July picnickers in Griffith Park's Fern Dell received some friendly reminders yesterday about keeping the picnic area free of litter.

The reminders came from Pat Martell and Margaret Wright, immediate Heart College students who offered to help Park's cartoon cartoon, in enforcing the picnic ground.

The girls are the first of a group of immaculate Heart College students who will visit the Fern Dell area each Sunday through the week of July 12.

More than 500 girls at the college pledged themselves to the cleanup campaign and will take part in the weekly Sunday patrol in Fern Dell under the direction of Sgt. S. J. Smith, the college's sports director.

Comic Dictionary INSATURATION When a young girl suffers from a severe case of fever, COMIC 1954, by Bruce B.

Here See Fireworks Display

Americana Shown in Flashing Color in Annual Spectacle

'Americana'—from the Boston Tea Party, the Alamo and all the great war—unfolded in flashing, burning color before an estimated 70,000 persons last night at the 22nd annual July 4 fireworks show staged by the Los Angeles County Council of the American Legion in the Coliseum.

A spectacular average by 32 Air Force jet planes from the 27th Air Division, Norton Air Force Base, thundering low over the rim of the stadium, opened the program.

The traditional match-lighting of the Coliseum, which each year in the audience struts a match at a given signal, brightened the blackened stadium and brought gasps of pleasure from hundreds of thousands of high point in the entertainment was a helicopter aloft to render demonstration and a "copper police" performed in a Navy cart by Lt. Edwin C. Moore.

There was a musical medley, featuring the U.S. Naval Training Center Band from San Diego, the Glendale Post No. 127 Drum and Bugle Corps, the Community Post No. 66 Drum and Bugle Corps and similar corps from Wilmington Post No. 267 and Santa Ana Post No. 111.

The famed Elks Motorcycle Corp. of Huntington Park, Calif., offered their thrilling feats. A drum and bugle corps of recruits from the Naval Training Center, a band of "Amateur Corps for Freedom" in which their participants, and musical, outstanding events in the nation's history.

The fireworks display commenced at 9:30 p.m. and lasted for 11 minutes, including a 10-minute display of fireworks.

Marked elsewhere Independence Day was marked in many other Southern California communities yesterday.

There were programs at Val Verde and Plummer Parks, raising of the Filipino flag at the where it is a winner of the Turn to Page 2, Column 1

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BY THE WAY...with BILL HENRY

WASHINGTON—Imagine the embarrassment of our United States Senate which had been worrying about their security matter when it suddenly found out to the fact that it was going to have to vote on a tax bill which was financially sound but politically indefensible.

TAX BILL—That was the situation faced by the Senate yesterday when it was to vote on a tax bill which was financially sound but politically indefensible.

more aggravating, and a little more human, the Senate had, as usual and with all the care of a four-point plan, been waiting until the moment, waited until the most embarrassing possible moment. Here they were, particularly the Republicans, faced with a tough tax bill, with practically no Senate majority, and with only a few days before the long July 4 holiday week end, and with all the political weapons in the hands of the Democrats who were laughing themselves all at the position in which the Republicans found themselves.

It all wonder that against Republican Senators, particularly those who had run for reelection this past, particularly the gun. They answered the tax bill leadership pointed out their political vulnerability and demanded a change in plans which would make the Republicans, on the one hand, and the Democrats, on the other, to vote. There was a lot of head scratching and soul searching and a lot of burning of the midnight oil and finally the Republicans came up with the bright idea that it would make the Democrats look good and to offer to cut taxes for the mysterious common man, it would make the Republicans look good if they made the same proposal.

So, at we shall see in tomorrow's column, the howls raised out to millions of people who were being offered a tax cut, it would make the Democrats look good and to offer to cut taxes for the mysterious common man, it would make the Republicans look good if they made the same proposal.

Line in Bill Henry Monday Night, July 5, 1954

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PARKY'S HELPERS—Patty Martell, left, and Margaret Wright, fourth from left, girls wearing hats, show Park cleanup deals to Fern Dell picknickers, left to right: Nancy Slusser, Milton Slusser, Mrs. Charlotte Slusser, Mrs. Irma Hucksman and Mrs. John Slusser, partly hidden by fireflies. Girls offered to help keep the city parks clean.

Times photo



VICTIM OF WILD DOGS—Arthur R. Sanger, 68, is convinced skeleton of boy he found on San Nicolas Island is that of baby, killed by wild dogs, of the Indian woman who in 19th century was left on island.

Times photo

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**Bones Believed
Those of Mystery
Hermit's Child**

BY TED SELL

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And it isn't a skeleton that Sanger is ashamed of. Indeed, he's proud of it.

The skeleton, Sanger believes, is that of the dead child of the 19th century hermit of San Nicolas Island.

The hermit, a figure of mystery in Southern California history, was a woman left behind and alone when the last of the San Nicolas Indians were removed from the island in 1835.

As the *Peor es Nada* started to sail, an Indian woman leaped ashore to gather up (so history has it) her baby, overlooked when the surviving score of Indians were brought to the ship.

Marooned on Island

A storm drove away the boat and the woman was doomed to 18 lonely years on the wind-whipped island.

When she was taken off by another vessel in 1853, she told her rescuers that her baby had been killed by wild dogs years earlier.

Sanger's skeleton, he believes

earlier.

Sanger's skeleton, he believes, is that of the child for whose life a mother became a solitary seal hunter on San Nicolas.

Found in a mound atop another mound of sand, Sanger's skeleton was buried with beads which, he has determined, must have been imported to the island at a fairly late date.

Of Recent Origin

The fact that the skeleton itself has not been uncovered by the constant gales sweeping the island, Sanger says, is evidence that the grave was of fairly recent origin. Most relics, the independent 68-year-old archeologist said, are unearthed by the winds rearranging island sands.

The skeleton is that of a small child, buried according to Indian custom in a fetal position.

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Veteran Port Sergeant Ends Active Career

One of the last early day Harbor Division policemen and port sergeant, William (Bill) Edwards, veteran dock sergeant at Harbor Division headquarters in San Pedro, who joined the police force Sept. 15, 1927, has served as dock sergeant at Wilmington and San Pedro for 25 years of his 27 years of service. He was stationed in Wilmington for six years prior to becoming dock sergeant and later spent an additional nine years there. The last 12 years he has been in San Pedro.

Dignified Card

Capt. Paul Stanley, head of the San Pedro police division, presented a "dignified card" to Edwards with the comment that it was a "well-earned honor."

The couple have built a house later and plan to leave on an extended fishing and hunting trip through the country. He was stationed throughout the United States as a patrol retirement dinner Edwards' daughter, Mrs. Doris, party given at the Police De-



EX-MISS AMERICA WED—Yolande Betts, 24, of Mobile, Ala., Miss America of 1951, poses with bridegroom, TV Producer Matthew Fox, 40, after marriage at the Van Nuys home of Nathan Blumberg.

Jeffrey Alan Allen, a nurse, will perform Flato, Grand on Tuesday, July 13, last Wednesday night, when fellow officers of the San Pedro Police Department will be present. Allen, who is a student body president at the same school.

The committee selected the winners by posing of William Severns, Bowdman, Edward Warner, assistant manager, and Edwin Goldfarb, head usher.

BOWL

physician-chess competition. Albert Greenstein, also of Toronto, attending U.C.L.A., where he edited a daily newspaper; and Benjamin W. Braunstein of Winnipeg, Can., U.C.L.A. student.

Musicians Included

Among the tubers are a dozen pianists, violinists, flutists, several singers and a French horn player.

Kevin Whelan of Hollywood High School, son of the laborer, vice-president of the County Youth Coordinating Council and president of the Boy's Life Club, and for two years was All-City swimming champion.

Harvey Gelman, another swimmer, was president of the Dorsey High School Student Council and Dennis Wheeler was student body president at the same school.

The committee selected the winners by posing of William Severns, Bowdman, Edward Warner, assistant manager, and Edwin Goldfarb, head usher.

Protest Filed on Refuse Yard

A petition from adjacent property owners has been filed for a municipal refuse collection in granting a permit for a refuse yard on 11 acres at the northeast corner of Pasadena and Van Allen aye. in San Fernando Valley.

INDIAN WHALE EFFIGIES—These are Chumash Indian tribal whale effigies, fashioned out of rock, and

SKELETON MYSTERY SC Student Critical of Life in Guatemala

Continued from First Page
explained, "that a man should leave the world in the position in which he entered it."

The skeleton is only one of literally thousands of Indian relics Sanger has stored, carefully numbered, at his home. A master log records the date and place of collection, the discovery of symbols of Indian ornaments, beads and other artifacts.

Theories in Museum
Additional thousands of Sanger's discoveries are at the Museum of the Americas Indian in New York. Sanger, for 30 years a real estate broker some of the time, archeologist, the rest, pursued some of his work for the Henry Foundation, operator of the museum.

An additional 85 of his finds are at the Los Angeles County Museum of Natural History. Most of the relics were found on islands spread like rocky, moss-covered, seaweed-strewn waters.

Some relics also came from excavations Sanger made 17 miles north of Malibu in the San Gabriel Valley.

Chumash Tribes Believed
Much of the relics are of the Chumash Tribe, a relatively advanced group of Indians living in the Santa Barbara district, said Sanger says, but the Chumash Indians, the beads and other artifacts for a brief period in which he and his sister, Mrs. Agnes, lived in the islands with no little skill at working with stone implements.

They were collected during 30 years of exploring for Sanger's brother, from 1920 to 1950 he maintained his own archaeological school, the 75-foot Old Dreamer, for his archeological trips to the seven islands.

In 1945 he traveled the schools for a brief period in which he and his sister, Mrs. Agnes, lived in the islands with no little skill at working with stone implements.

3 Times Around U.S.
"I've been completely around the country three times and I'm still here," he said.

But Sanger's first love is archeological research into the history and life of the coastal Indians—with emphasis on the history of the Chumash Indians natives of the islands where the things needed for life were brought ashore.

Other archeologists and anthropologists have speculated that the ease of life on the stormy islands was indeed the factor which made the Indians easy prey to marauding Russians and Aleuts during earlier expeditions of the late 18th and early 19th centuries.

It was to save the last San Nicolas islands from the hands of the first who visited the island in 1835—and left the island there.

found by Arthur R. Sanger of Los Angeles on San Nicolas Island during one of his excavation trips.

Native of Spain Deported, Readmitted; Spent Three Months in Honduras

"I've just come back from three and a half months in Honduras and Guatemala, and I believe so, I'm glad I can live in the United States."

"Life is utterly miserable for most of the people of small countries like those in Central America."

"Those statements were made yesterday by Julian Engquist, graduate student at the University of Southern California, who was last readmitted into this country. He is a native of Spain."

Via San Out
His student visa ran out last January and he wanted to change it to permanent residence, but he was deported. This last his wife and 50-day-old baby daughter along with no funds.

Engquist's passport turned out to be a straightened-out one, thanks to the efforts of his wife, friends and SC professors who insisted money and wrote letters to the Immigration authorities.

Engquist said he is looking forward to being a citizen in 1956.

The Italian official who accompanied by ARCUE executive, including Fortune Press of New York City, national chairman; Frank N. Belgrave, Jr. of San Francisco, assistant chairman; and Amerigo D'Agostino, of Washington, D.C., secretary.

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FIREWORKS

Continued from First Page
the Los Angeles City Hall by members of the Malibu Post American Legion, a fiesta at Montebello Stadium by Legion Post 804, a helicopter rescue and fireworks at San Fernando Valley Fairgrounds in Northridge, fireworks at San Fernando Recreation Park, and the Union Club fireworks in Compton. New Year's were open to visit new at each beach, as beauty contest, aquatic, fireworks and street dancing at Redondo Beach, concerts, sports events and fireworks at South Gate, beach races and other activities through Orange County.

At 8:15 p.m. today Pasadena's Rose Bowl will be the scene of the 26th annual circus and fireworks show sponsored by the Pasadena Fire Department.



INDIAN WHALE EFFIGIES—These are Chumash Indian tribal whale effigies, fashioned out of rock, and

found by Arthur R. Sanger of Los Angeles on San Nicolas Island during one of his excavation trips.

Times photo

SELECTIONS

Continued from First Page
er explained, "that a man should leave the world in the position in which he entered it."

The skeleton is only one of literally thousands of Indian relics Sanger has stored, carefully numbered, at his home. A master log records the date and place and circumstances of discovery of myriads of Indian mortars and pestles, effigies, ornaments, beads and other discoveries.

Discoveries in Museum

Additional thousands of Sanger's discoveries are at the Museum of the American Indian in New York. Sanger, for 30 years a real estate broker some of the time, archeologist the rest, pursued some of his work for the Heye Foundation, operators of the museum.

An additional 85 of his finds are at the Los Angeles County Museum, he said.

Most of the relics were found, Sanger said, on the seven Channel Islands spread like a rocky

Sanger said, on the seven Channel Islands spread like a rocky crescent athwart the offshore waters.

Some relics also came from excavations Sanger made 17 miles north of Malibu in the Arroyo Sequit.

Chumash Tribe Relics

Much of the finds were those of the Chumash Tribe, a relatively advanced Indian nation living in the Santa Barbara district and, Sanger says, on the Channel Islands.

The beadwork and other artifacts show great patience and no little skill at working with crude implements.

They were collected during 30 years of exploring by Sanger, a bachelor. From 1909 to 1945 he maintained his own auxiliary schooner, the 72-foot Old Dreamer, for his archeological trips to the seven islands.

In 1945 he traded the schooner for a 16-foot trailer in which he and his sister, Mrs. Agnes Sanger Mulden, now explore the United States.

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3 Times Around U.S.

"We've been completely around the country three times since then," he said.

But Sanger's first love is archeological research into the customs and history of the coastal Indians—with emphasis on the history of the ill-fated Channel Islands natives destroyed, as it were, by the idyllic life they led on the islands where the things needed for life were brought easily.

Other archeologists and anthropologists have speculated that the ease of life on the storm-swept islands was indeed the factor which made the Indians easy prey to marauding Russians and Aleuts during sea-otter expeditions of the late 18th and early 19th centuries.

It was to save the last San Nicolas Islanders from the raiders that the Peor Es Nada visited the island in 1835—and left the single woman ashore.

Bitter Over Closing

Of governmental closing of the islands, Sanger has bitter

words. He fears that closing many of the best archeological hunting grounds will mean the irrevocable loss of relics they contain.

"The wind uncovers them," he explained, "and they'll disintegrate. They should let the pot hunters collect them, to save them."

Sanger says, however, that mainland diggings, such as those at the Arroyo Sequit, should be excavated only under direction of trained archeologists.

"But the situation is different there," he adds. "There's no danger of them being lost unless careless diggers haul them away. On the islands, the things will be lost."

Five Navy-Controlled

Of the seven islands, five are under partial or complete control of the Navy, Sanger said. They are Santa Cruz, San Nicolas, San Miguel, Santa Rosa and San Clemente. The last has been blasted by Navy guns as a bombardment range.

Among the items carefully saved by Sanger are several skulls, in two of which arrow heads are firmly imbedded as a result of what apparently was

heads are firmly imbedded as a result of what apparently was tribal warfare or murder.

Another skull, Sanger said, belongs to a skeleton which he found practically intact. In the spinal column of that skeleton, he pointed out, is welded firmly a large spear point, apparently driven through the victim in what Sanger thinks might have been a ritual murder. The skull, with teeth not worn down by Indian eating habits, is different from those of Indians found nearby.

Good Luck Effigies

Also in Sanger's collection are whale effigies, used to bring good luck to Indian fishermen, he explained. All have been laboriously shaped from rock and are complete to the sculptured spray spout. One is worn by constant rubbing which Sanger says apparently took the place of prayer for good fishing.

Other effigies are of a grizzly bear and sea turtles.

Indian beads—for the most part made of handworked abalone shell flakes—and trade beads, imported by Russian and Spanish explorers, also fill display cases in Sanger's cabinets.